

that your business would require in a typical Vista deployment, and that one-CD requirement can easily become a DVD worth of data, if not more.

The good news is that like the previous iteration, Vista supports deployment from various resources, be they local such as an optical disc, or networked. You could also deploy Vista on a USB memory stick, if you have one large enough (and if your BIOS supports USB booting). Finally, the I386 directory no longer exists. Instead, all components, whether installed or not, reside in the Windows directory.

1.4.2. Implications of enhanced security

The new security features under Vista will also change the deployment environment a bit. Under Vista, even an administrator account does not have all the rights needed to make system-level changes. These rights are throttled to a higher-level, as and when needed, by Vista's User Access Control (UAC) system. Interestingly though, non-admin accounts can install drivers under Vista, which should reduce support calls from employees installing their own hardware on their PC. A possible support headache to keep in mind while deploying is that Vista no longer grants full rights to all programs—thus, programs which assumed access to drives and registry under Windows XP will be redirected automatically by Windows Vista to other directories under the user's profile.

Vista's firewall is now two-way, instead of just inbound like it was under XP. This new firewall is fully configurable via Group Policy.

Windows Vista Ultimate and Enterprise versions ship with BitLocker, which allows entire drives to be encrypted (the OS volume). The encrypted volume can be read using the right keys and only from Vista. BitLocker requires that your motherboard support the Trusted Platform Module (TPM) 1.2. The unlock key can be stored externally on a USB drive.